

Homewise VOC Interview Notes #4

Before the interview (screener, done async or in first 2 min)

- Have you hired a contractor (plumber, electrician, HVAC, roofer, handyman, remodeler, etc. all count!) before?

I recently worked on my front and backyard.

- Roughly what did the project cost? (A range is fine. Ideally, we want a mix: small repairs, bigger projects)

About \$10,000.

- Do you own your home?

Yes.

Warm-up

1. Tell me a bit about your home — how long have you owned it, and how often do you find yourself needing to hire someone for projects or repairs?

I bought the house three years ago, and recently I've been working on renovating the front and backyard.

The Recent Experience

Anchor everything on one specific recent hire. Don't let them generalize.

2. Walk me through the **last time** you hired a contractor. Start from the moment you realized you needed one.

I bought the house three years ago and recently decided to redo the front and backyard.

3. How did you find them? What sources did you use? (Let them list — don't prompt.)

I saw the contractor working in the neighborhood, liked the quality of his work, and asked him to come take a look at my place.

4. How did you decide which ones to contact? What made you rule some out?

I looked at his past work and talked to neighbors he had worked for, then decided to hire him without contacting others.

5. How many quotes did you get? How did you compare them?

Only one quote. I didn't really compare.

6. How did you know if the price was fair?

I have some prior experience, and it felt reasonable to me.

7. What did you do (if anything) to check if they were licensed, insured, or reputable?

His business card had his license number.

8. Walk me through scheduling and the actual work — how did that go?

We discussed timing and duration upfront, and the work was mostly completed as planned.

9. After the work was done, what happened with paperwork, receipts, warranties?

He didn't provide full paperwork or warranties, only some receipts.

If you find someone trustworthy, would you hire them again?

Yes.

Do you want to refer the contractor to someone else?

Yes, if the experience was good.

Pain Point

10. What was the **most frustrating part** of that whole experience?

The materials he purchased were not the color I wanted, which caused some waste.

11. If you could change one thing about hiring a contractor, what would it be?

I would personally be involved in selecting and purchasing key materials.

Current Workarounds & Prior Spending

12. Is there anything you do today to make hiring contractors easier — spreadsheets, apps, asking neighbors?

Now I tend to look at neighbors' actual projects first and spend more time aligning on details upfront before starting.

13. Have you ever paid for a service to help you find or vet contractors (Angi, Thumbtack, etc.)? What was that like?

No.

Wrap-up

14. Looking back on that whole experience — finding, hiring, and working with the contractor — how would you describe it in a few words?

Relatively smooth overall, but with some regrets in the details.

15. Is there anything about hiring contractors I didn't ask about that I should have?

It would be helpful to ask who has final decision-making authority on materials, and how responsibility is handled if the wrong materials are chosen.

16. Do you know 1–2 other homeowners who've hired contractors recently who might be open to a similar chat?

Yes, I have one or two neighbors who recently worked on their yard or home renovations and might be open to it.